

11. Header Linked List

–Traverse In Order

Program:

```
void destroyList()
{
    Node *current = head->next; // Start after header
    Node *nextNode;

    while (current != nullptr)
    {
        nextNode = current->next;
        free(current);
        current = nextNode;
    }

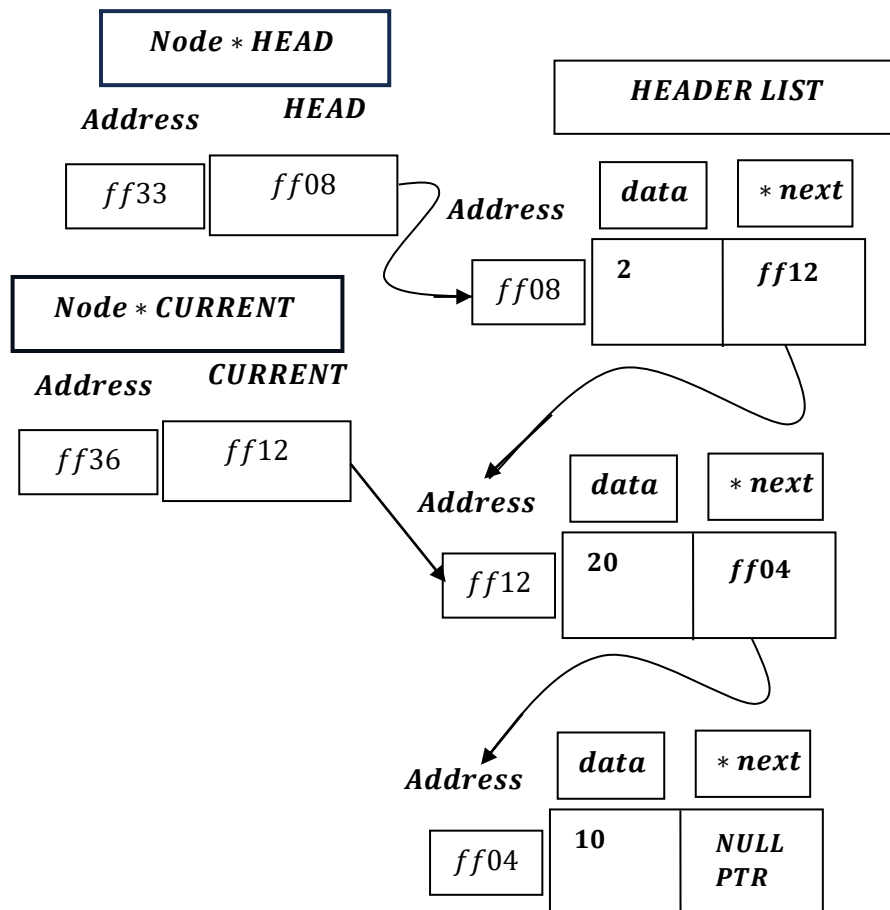
    // Reset header
    head->next = nullptr;
    head->data = 0;

    cout << "List cleared (Header node preserved)." << endl;
}
...

case 9:
    destroyList();
    break;
```

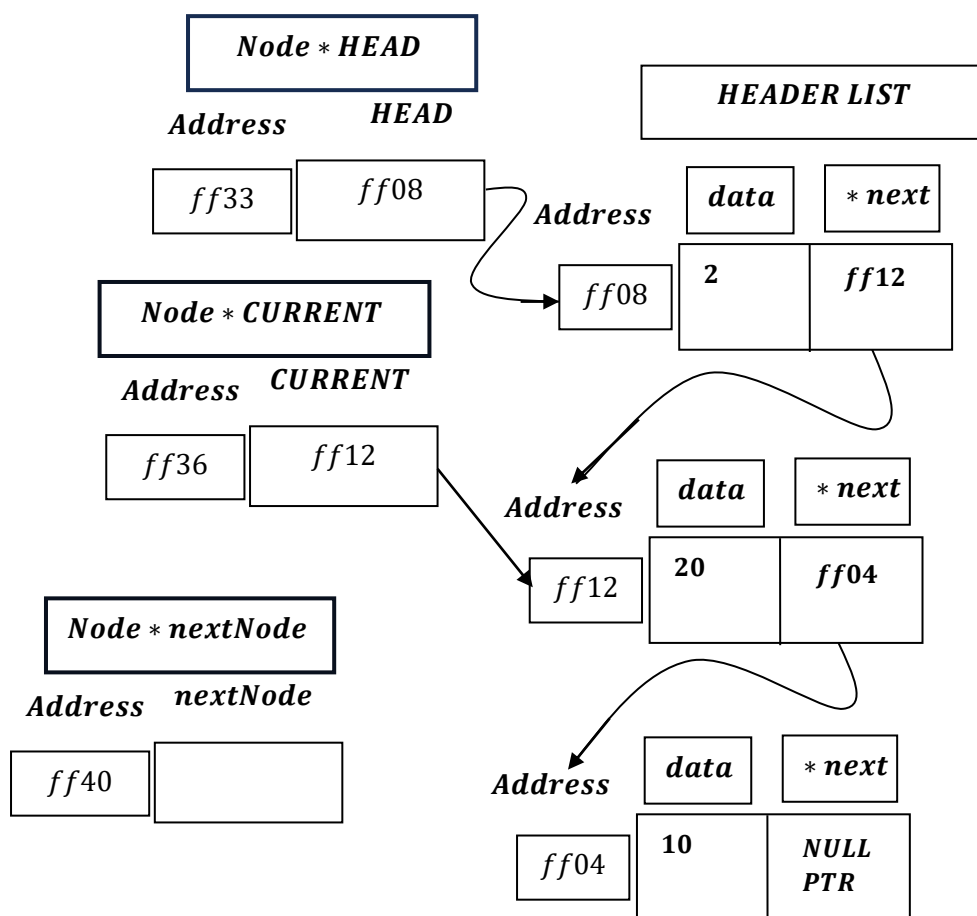
Program Analysis

```
Node *current = head->next; // Start after header  
Node *CURRENT = HEAD → NEXT = ff12.
```



```
Node *nextNode;
```

Declare Node * nextNode;



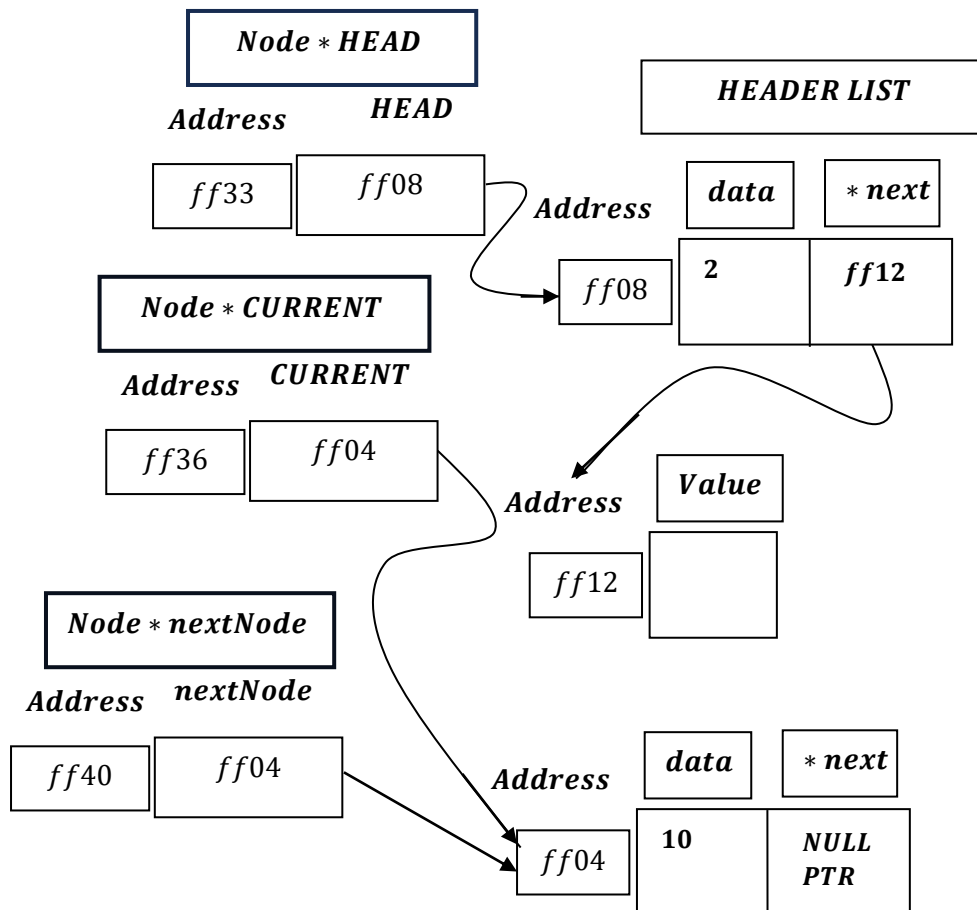
```
while (current != nullptr)
{
    nextNode = current->next;
    free(current);
    current = nextNode;
}
```

CURRENT: ff12 $\neq$ NULLPTR :

nextNode = current $\rightarrow$ next = ff04;

free(current: ff12);

current = nextNode = ff04;

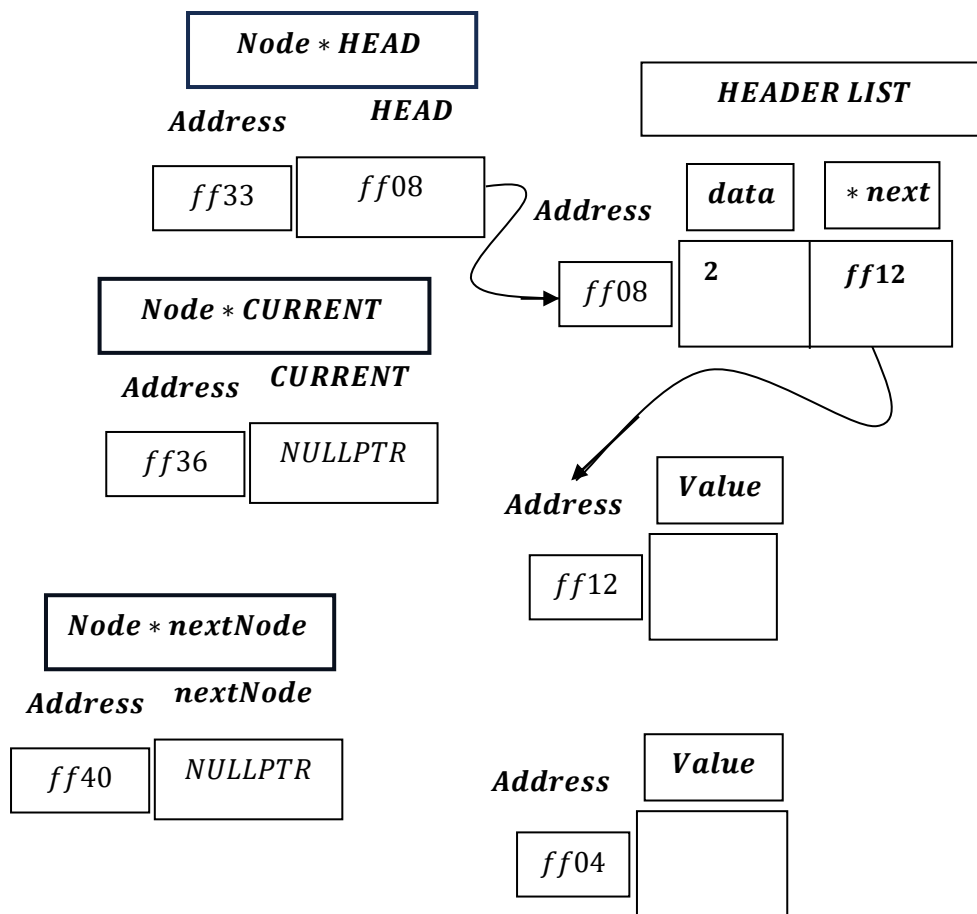


CURRENT: ff04 $\neq$ NULLPTR :

nextNode = current $\rightarrow$ next = NULLPTR;

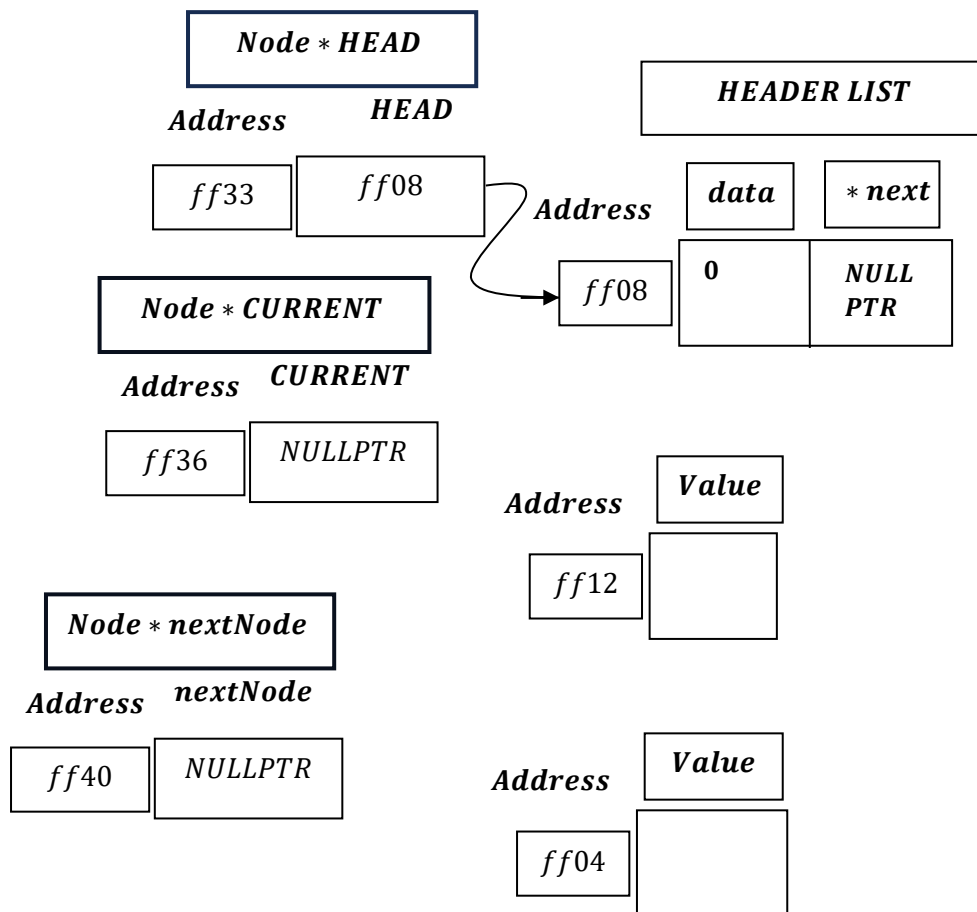
free(current: ff04);

current = nextNode = NULLPTR;



CURRENT: NULLPTR $\neq$ NULLPTR is false and hence exit from the loop.

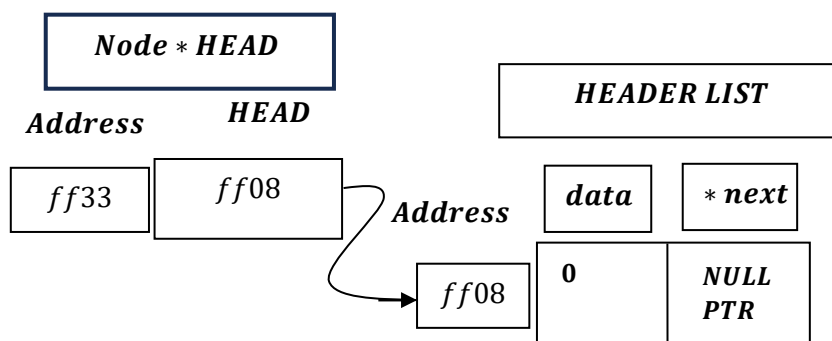
```
head->next = nullptr;
head->data = 0;
```



```
cout << "List cleared (Header node preserved)." << endl;
```

Output: Print → ``List cleared(Header node preserved).``

Hence, after destroying the list we have :



Therefore, Header Node is preserved , and remain undestroyed , even if the list is fully destroyed.
